INSTITUT PRIVÉ DE LANGUES LES SAGES (ILAS)
ILAS LANGUAGE INSTITUTE • ACCREDITED TRAINING CENTER
Ministerial Authorization N° 22-200/2020 • Deroua | Phone: 06 70 38 48 73 / 06 60 29 11 55

COMMON EUROPEAN FRAMEWORK OF REFERENCE FOR LANGUAGES (CEFR) • LEVEL B1

ENGLISH B1 CERTIFICATE

OFFICIAL CANDIDATE EXAMINATION BOOKLET

Standardized Examination Papers for International B1 English Language Competency

CANDIDATE INFORMATION / DONNÉES DU CANDIDAT

EXAMINATION CENTER: ILAS DEROUA

FULL NAME (NOM & PRÉNOM): **BENYAHIA, Anass**	DATE OF BIRTH (DATE DE NAISSANCE): **26.01.2007**
NATIONAL ID / CIN: **WB226817**	CANDIDATE ID (N° CANDIDAT): **ILAS-ENG-B1-2026-WB226817**
EXAM DATE (DATE D'EXAMEN): **16 October 2026**	EXAMINATION TYPE: **Full B1 Certificate (All Modules)**

Examination Module	Duration	Max. Points	Score Achieved
Part 1: Reading (Reading Comprehension)	45 Min.	25 Points	____ / 25
Part 2: Listening (Listening Comprehension)	30 Min.	25 Points	____ / 25
Part 3: Language in Use (Grammar & Vocabulary)	25 Min.	15 Points	____ / 15
Part 4: Writing (Written Expression)	50 Min.	20 Points	____ / 20
Part 5: Speaking (Oral Expression & Interaction)	15 Min.	15 Points	____ / 15
OVERALL RESULT (Total)	**165 Min.**	**100 Points**	**____ / 100**

Important Instructions for Examination Candidates:

- **Prohibited Items:** Dictionaries, mobile phones, and smart devices are strictly forbidden.
- **Writing Pen:** Use only ballpoint pens with blue or black ink. Pencil is not permitted.
- **Responses:** Record your answers clearly in the designated check boxes and lines.
- **Passing Grade:** A minimum of **60 points (60 %)** is required to pass B1.

CANDIDATE SIGNATURE

I hereby certify the accuracy of my details and work.

PART 1: READING COMPREHENSION

Duration: 45 Min. (Part 1 total) | Max. 25 Points

TASK 1: READING AN IN-DEPTH BUSINESS ARTICLE

10 Points (2 points per question)

Read the following article from a business journal and answer questions 1 to 5. Mark the correct answer (a, b, or c).

The Four-Day Work Week: Future Workplace Model or Economic Risk?

Across the world, an increasing number of companies are exploring a radical transformation of the workplace: introducing a four-day work week with full wage compensation. This arrangement means that employees work 32 or 35 hours over four days instead of the traditional 40 hours across five days, while receiving the exact same monthly salary into their bank accounts. What once sounded like an unrealistic demand from labor unions is now being tested by numerous craft businesses, manufacturing facilities, and tech companies in real workplace conditions.

One prominent example is Markus Weber's plumbing and heating company in Cologne. Two years ago, Weber found it nearly impossible to recruit qualified technicians. Young candidates openly stated during job interviews that personal time, health, and family were far more important to them than earning extra pay through overtime. In response, Weber completely restructured his operations: his 18 staff members now work nine hours a day from Monday to Thursday, while the headquarters remains closed on Fridays – with the exception of an emergency on-call service organized on weekly rotation.

The outcome astonished even the business owner himself. "In the beginning, I was deeply worried that we wouldn't finish client orders on time and would lose our customer base," admits Weber. Yet the exact opposite occurred: the number of sick days dropped by almost 40 percent in the first year. Moreover, internal workflows were digitized and unnecessary meetings were eliminated, leading to a substantial increase in productivity per working hour. The recruitment crisis was resolved as well: since the change, Weber has received more than 50 unsolicited applications from highly skilled workers.

Despite these inspiring success stories, economic experts caution against imposing a mandatory four-day week across all sectors by law. In public hospitals, emergency transit systems, and the hospitality sector, tasks cannot simply be carried out faster. If a bus driver works 20 percent fewer hours, buses inevitably run 20 percent less frequently – unless additional drivers are hired, who are already in severe shortage in the labor market. A four-day work week is therefore a powerful strategy for individual enterprises, but by no means a one-size-fits-all solution for the entire economy.

1. What is meant by a four-day work week "with full wage compensation"?

- ☐ **a)** Employees work ten hours every day for four days to earn the same salary.
- ☐ **b)** Employees work fewer total hours per week while receiving the same salary.
- ☐ **c)** Employees accept a 20 percent pay reduction in order to take Fridays off.

2. Why did Markus Weber decide to introduce the four-day week in his company?

- ☐ **a)** Because his staff members were constantly taking sick leave and making errors.
- ☐ **b)** Because labor authorities and unions legally compelled his business to do so.
- ☐ **c)** Because he faced severe difficulties in attracting qualified, skilled workers.

3. How is working time organized in Weber's company today?

- ☐ **a)** Every single employee has Friday off without any exception whatsoever.
- ☐ **b)** Staff work longer shifts over four days, with only an emergency team on Friday.
- ☐ **c)** Individual workers choose flexibly on their own which four days to attend.

4. What was the direct result of this reorganization for Weber's business?

- ☐ **a)** Employees took significantly fewer sick days and demonstrated greater focus.
- ☐ **b)** Several loyal clients transferred to competitors because of Friday closure.
- ☐ **c)** Staff spent excessive hours in prolonged discussions about software upgrades.

5. Why are economic experts skeptical about enforcing a four-day week across all sectors?

- ☐ **a)** Because the majority of workers in modern industry prefer working five days.
- ☐ **b)** Because in essential service professions, reduced hours cannot be compensated by faster work.
- ☐ **c)** Because implementing technology in municipal buses and clinics is too expensive.

TASK 2: READERS' OPINIONS & LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

10 Points (2 points per question)

Read the three opinion pieces on the topic **"Should city centers become completely car-free?"** and evaluate statements 6–10: **True [T]** or **False [F]**.

Post 1 – Sabine K. (44, Shop Owner)

"Banning cars entirely from city centers would mean financial ruin for many independent retailers. My customers frequently travel from suburban areas specifically to make substantial purchases. Nobody wants to haul heavy shopping bags on crowded trams for miles. Before banning cars, municipal authorities must first build free park-and-ride facilities on the outskirts and cut public transit fares in half."

Post 2 – Lukas M. (29, Architect)

"I live right downtown and can hardly tolerate the noise, fumes, and traffic congestion anymore. Forward-thinking cities like Copenhagen and Amsterdam have shown that pedestrian zones dramatically enhance quality of life! People relax at open-air cafés where bumper-to-bumper traffic once crawled, and store revenues have actually climbed because pedestrians and cyclists stop to browse far more spontaneously than drivers."

Post 3 – Herbert W. (68, Retiree)

"This discussion is far too polarized. Naturally, we should reduce urban traffic, but an outright ban completely marginalizes elderly or mobility-impaired individuals who depend on vehicles. An urban congestion toll for non-essential drivers would be much more sensible than a total prohibition. Craftsmen, delivery vehicles, and local residents should, of course, continue to enter free of charge."

Statement regarding the texts	True	False
6. Sabine K. is concerned that suburban customers will stop shopping at her store if cars are banned.	☐	☐
7. Sabine K. believes that public transportation fares are already sufficiently inexpensive.	☐	☐
8. Lukas M. believes that shops in car-free urban areas experience lower retail turnover than before.	☐	☐
9. Herbert W. supports allowing disabled and elderly citizens to continue accessing the city center by car.	☐	☐
10. Herbert W. recommends that local residents and repair contractors should also be required to pay the congestion charge.	☐	☐

TASK 3: MATCHING PROFILES & COURSE ADVERTISEMENTS

5 Points (1 point per question)

Which training course (A–G) matches which person's requirements (11–15)? For one person, there is **NO** suitable course (write "**0**").

People & Situations:

11. Mrs. Yilmaz (Accountant): Wants to master complex spreadsheets and automated calculations on PC. Only free on weekends. [ ]

12. Mr. Bergmann: Newly promoted department head. Anxious about public speaking and seeks vocal and confidence training. [ ]

13. Leonie (19): Looking for a 4-week morning intensive Business English course to prepare for university degree. [ ]

14. Mr. Kovac: Manages a team troubled by frequent workplace disputes. Wants to acquire professional mediation techniques. [ ]

15. Mrs. Lindner: Works remotely from home, suffers chronic back pain, and seeks a relaxing evening wellness class on Tuesdays or Thursdays. [ ]

Course Offerings:

A **Confident Public Speaking – Rhetoric & Presentation:** Voice coaching, stage fright reduction. Wednesdays, 18:00–21:00 (3 sessions).

B **Business English – Evening Masterclass (B2):** Professional fluency. Mondays & Wednesdays, 19:00–20:30 over 12 weeks.

C **Advanced MS Excel for Financial Data:** Formulas, pivot tables & analysis. Weekend Intensive: Sat & Sun, 09:00–16:30.

D **Workplace Conflict Management:** Mediate disputes constructively and reach fair solutions as a leader. Friday, 09:00–17:00.

E **Fit & Pain-Free at Your Desk:** Targeted back exercises & relaxation for office workers. Tuesdays, 18:30–20:00.

F **Remote IT Security & Data Privacy:** Technical hands-on workshop for network admins. Thursday, 14:00–18:00.

G **Accounting for Startups & Entrepreneurs:** Invoicing, taxes, and bookkeeping rules. Saturday, 10:00–15:00.

PART 2: LISTENING COMPREHENSION

Duration: 30 Min. | Max. 25 Points

Note: Audio passages will be read aloud or played by examiners. Mark your answers directly while listening.

TASK 1: SHORT ANNOUNCEMENTS & MESSAGES (Listen ONCE)

10 Points (2 points per question)

You will hear five short announcements on the telephone or radio. You will hear each text **ONCE**. Choose the correct answer (a, b, or c).

16. What must Mrs. Schneider do before coming to the clinic tomorrow?

- ☐ **a)** Call to reschedule her appointment because the doctor is ill.
- ☐ **b)** Bring her new health insurance card and current medication list.
- ☐ **c)** Arrive thirty minutes later than originally scheduled.

17. Why is the regional train RB 42 not reaching Central Station?

- ☐ **a)** Urgent repair works on a railway bridge following storm damage.
- ☐ **b)** A city-wide strike by regional railway personnel.
- ☐ **c)** A defective locomotive blocking the approach platform.

18. What weather is forecast for the southern region this weekend?

- ☐ **a)** Continuous sunny weather throughout with highs above 25°C.
- ☐ **b)** Heavy unexpected snowfall down to valley levels.
- ☐ **c)** Warm on Saturday, followed by storms and cooler air Sunday.

19. Why is the furniture store representative calling Mr. Albers?

- ☐ **a)** The dining table and chairs can be delivered early this Friday.
- ☐ **b)** The chairs were damaged during transit and must be re-ordered.
- ☐ **c)** Mr. Albers needs to transfer the remaining invoice balance first.

20. What must visitors remember if visiting the City Museum this Sunday?

- ☐ **a)** Museum admission is completely free for all visitors on Sunday.
- ☐ **b)** Due to the City Marathon, cars cannot access the museum (use Subway Line 4).
- ☐ **c)** The second-floor special exhibition closes early at 14:00.

TASK 2: RADIO INTERVIEW (Apprenticeship or University? – Listen TWICE)

10 Points (2 points per question)

Interview with career consultant Thomas Richter. You will hear the dialogue **TWICE**. Mark: **True [T]** or **False [F]**.

Statement regarding the radio interview	True	False
21. Mr. Richter says that nearly 80 percent of school leavers today choose to pursue a university degree.	☐	☐
22. Many university students drop out because they had inaccurate expectations regarding academic theory and self-discipline.	☐	☐
23. According to Mr. Richter, skilled tradespeople always earn substantially less than university graduates.	☐	☐
24. A "dual study programme" combines practical employment in a company with university lectures.	☐	☐
25. Mr. Richter urges parents to push their children toward whatever career offers the greatest social prestige.	☐	☐

TASK 3: WORKPLACE CONVERSATION (Annual Company Outing – Listen ONCE)

5 Points (1 point per question)

Conversation between colleagues Anna and David. You will hear the conversation **ONCE**. Who says what? Mark: **Anna [A]**, **David [D]**, or **Both [B]**.

Statement in the conversation	Anna [A]	David [D]	Both [B]
26. Last year's mountain hike was an unpleasant experience because of bad weather and heavy rain.	☐	☐	☐
27. A cooking masterclass for the whole team fosters closer collaboration than simply having dinner in a restaurant.	☐	☐	☐
28. The company budget of 50 Euros per person is not enough to cover an evening boat cruise with a full buffet.	☐	☐	☐
29. The outing should take place on a working Friday rather than asking employees to give up their Saturday.	☐	☐	☐
30. They should submit two different proposals to the boss so the entire department can vote via email.	☐	☐	☐

PART 3: LANGUAGE IN USE (GRAMMAR & VOCABULARY)

Duration: 25 Min. | Max. 15 Points

TASK 1: FORMAL CLOZE TEXT (INSURANCE CLAIM)

7.5 Points (0.75 points per gap)

Read the following formal notification letter and select the grammatically appropriate word for each gap (31–40).

Dear Sir or Madam,
I am writing to formally report an incident of water damage, **(31)** occurred last Tuesday in my rented apartment. When I returned home from work at approximately 6:00 p.m., I discovered **(32)** water had overflowed from the kitchen dishwasher. **(33)** I turned off the main shut-off valve immediately, water had already penetrated under **(34)** newly installed parquet floor in the corridor. The flooring, which **(35)** fitted just two years ago, has warped **(36)** and must now be replaced by a licensed contractor. I notified my landlord that very evening **(37)** inspect the extent of the damage. He advised me to get in touch with **(38)** insurance provider without delay. **(39)** it be possible for you to dispatch an insurance assessor this week? I will forward the contractor's formal quote **(40)** I receive it.
Yours faithfully, Martin Brenner

Gap 31:
[ ] a) whom
[ ] b) which
[ ] c) whose
[ ] d) what

Gap 32:
[ ] a) whether
[ ] b) because
[ ] c) that
[ ] d) when

Gap 33:
[ ] a) Despite
[ ] b) Although
[ ] c) Because of
[ ] d) During

Gap 34:
[ ] a) an
[ ] b) a
[ ] c) the
[ ] d) these

Gap 35:
[ ] a) was
[ ] b) has
[ ] c) is
[ ] d) been

Gap 36:
[ ] a) severely
[ ] b) severe
[ ] c) more severe
[ ] d) severity

Gap 37:
[ ] a) so that
[ ] b) in order to
[ ] c) for
[ ] d) unless

Gap 38:
[ ] a) my
[ ] b) mine
[ ] c) me
[ ] d) myself

Gap 39:
[ ] a) Would
[ ] b) Should
[ ] c) Were
[ ] d) Could

Gap 40:
[ ] a) as soon as
[ ] b) since
[ ] c) before
[ ] d) until

TASK 2: COMPLEX B1 GRAMMATICAL STRUCTURES

7.5 Points (0.75 points per question)

Choose the grammatically and semantically correct option (a, b, c, or d) to complete sentences 41 to 50.

41. The woman _____ handbag was stolen at the sidewalk café notified the police immediately.
[ ] a) who [ ] b) which [ ] c) whose [ ] d) whom

42. _____ asking a local resident for directions, my brother drove around lost for nearly two hours.
[ ] a) Without [ ] b) Instead of [ ] c) In order to [ ] d) Despite of

43. In our corporate department, all supplier invoices _____ verified electronically before payment.
[ ] a) must be [ ] b) are been [ ] c) have to [ ] d) should be to

44. Have you already introduced yourself to the new _____ from the international marketing team?
[ ] a) colleague [ ] b) colleague's [ ] c) colleagues [ ] d) collegial

45. _____ more frequently you practice speaking, _____ quicker you overcome linguistic hesitation.
[ ] a) Both / and [ ] b) Either / or [ ] c) The / the [ ] d) Not only / but

46. If I _____ in your position, I _____ accept such unfavorable contract conditions without negotiation.
[ ] a) am / will not [ ] b) were / would not [ ] c) had been / will not [ ] d) would be / do not

47. We were delighted _____ your recent inquiry and look forward _____ developing a productive partnership.
[ ] a) for / on [ ] b) about / in [ ] c) with / to [ ] d) by / toward

48. After the bilateral agreement _____ by both executives, the project officially commenced.
[ ] a) had been signed [ ] b) was signing [ ] c) has been signed [ ] d) would be signed

49. Passengers were instructed to keep their seatbelts fastened throughout _____ entire transatlantic flight.
[ ] a) a [ ] b) an [ ] c) the [ ] d) of

50. It is no longer mandatory _____ the application in person; candidates can submit documentation online.
[ ] a) submit [ ] b) for submit [ ] c) to submit [ ] d) submitting

PART 4: WRITING (WRITTEN EXPRESSION)

Total Duration: 50 Min. | Max. 20 Points (2 x 10 Pts.)

TASK 1: FORMAL COMPLAINT EMAIL / LETTER

10 Points • Recommended Time: ~25 Min. • Word Count: ~80–100 words

Situation: Two weeks ago, you purchased a premium espresso machine (Model: *"Barista Pro"*, Order Reference: **TW-9941**) for **£249 / 249€** from the online retailer *"TechWorld Ltd"*. After three days of normal use, the appliance malfunctioned (it no longer heats water). Your initial complaint email sent last week received no response.
Write a formal, assertive complaint email addressing all four guiding points.

REQUIRED CONTENT POINTS:

- **1. Purpose of writing** (purchase date, model, order ref.)
- **2. Problem description** & mention of unanswered first email
- **3. Clear remedy demanded:** free replacement or full refund
- **4. Set a firm deadline** (e.g., 7 days) & mention legal/consumer steps

ANSWER SHEET TASK 1 (FORMAL COMPLAINT EMAIL):

1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10
11
12
13

FOR EXAMINERS ONLY (TASK 1 EVALUATION):

CONTENT POINTS (4P)	COHERENCE & STYLE (3P)	GRAMMAR & VOCAB (3P)	TOTAL TASK 1
___ / 4	___ / 3	___ / 3	___ / 10

PART 4: WRITING • TASK 2

Recommended Time: ~25 Min. | Max. 10 Points

TASK 2: OPINION ESSAY / DISCUSSION FORUM CONTRIBUTION

10 Points • Word Count: ~100–120 words

Situation: You read an online article debating *"Working from Home or Returning to the Office?"*. The author claims provocatively that remote employees work less diligently, become lazy, and that team spirit is completely lost when people do not share a physical office.
Write a balanced, structured contribution expressing your perspective in the readers' forum.

REQUIRED CONTENT POINTS:

- **Personal Opinion:** State your position on the author's claim.
- **Balanced Arguments:** Present at least **two advantages** and **two disadvantages** of remote work.
- **Constructive Compromise:** Propose a **practical compromise** fair to both employers and staff.

ANSWER SHEET TASK 2 (DISCUSSION FORUM / OPINION ESSAY):

1
2
3
4
5
6
7
8
9
10
11
12
13

FOR EXAMINERS ONLY (TASK 2 EVALUATION):

OPINION & ARGUMENTS (4P)	CONNECTORS / STYLE (3P)	VOCABULARY & ACCURACY (3P)	TOTAL TASK 2
___ / 4	___ / 3	___ / 3	___ / 10

PART 5: SPEAKING (ORAL EXPRESSION & INTERACTION)

Preparation: 10 Min. | Exam Duration: ~15 Min. | Max. 15 Points

ORAL EXAMINATION PROCEDURES & GUIDELINES

Paired Examination or Individual Interview with Examiners

The speaking test comprises two distinct parts. During your 10-minute supervised preparation, you may write brief bullet points on scrap paper. Speak fluently, avoid reading verbatim, and engage actively with questions.

PART 5A: INDIVIDUAL PRESENTATION — 7.5 Points (~4–5 Min.)

Topic: "Social Media (Instagram, TikTok, LinkedIn): Blessing or Curse?"

Structure your presentation following these steps:

- **1. Introduction:** Introduce the topic and describe your personal habits and daily experience with social networks.
- **2. Situation in Home Country:** How are social platforms used in Morocco? What role do they play among youth and businesses?
- **3. Advantages & Disadvantages:** Discuss at least two specific benefits (e.g. global networking) and two drawbacks (screen addiction, privacy).
- **4. Conclusion & Recommendation:** Summarize your final stance and answer follow-up questions from the examiners.

Tip: Use structuring discourse markers (*"To begin with...", "On the one hand..., on the other hand...", "In my honest opinion..."*).

PART 5B: COLLABORATIVE PROBLEM-SOLVING — 7.5 Points (~6 Min.)

Scenario: Planning a Surprise Graduation Weekend for a Close Friend

Negotiate and plan together with your partner / examiner:

- **Destination & Lodging:** Coastal beach camping, a mountain cabin in the Atlas, or a city boutique hotel?
- **Transport & Mobility:** Booking train tickets, renting minivans, or organizing carpools among friends?
- **Budget & Costs:** What total budget per person is realistic for 15 friends? Who covers the graduate's portion?
- **Task Allocation:** Who handles bookings, who buys food and supplies, and who distracts the friend until the surprise?

Tip: Make constructive suggestions, listen to your partner's counterarguments, and negotiate an agreeable compromise.

OFFICIAL EXAMINER PROTOCOL – ORAL SPEAKING MODULE

CANDIDATE: ANASS BENYAHIA

Evaluation Criteria	Part 5A (Presentation)	Part 5B (Negotiation)	Overall Impression
1. Task Fulfillment, Discourse & Coherence	____ / 2.5 P.	____ / 2.5 P.	____ / 5.0 P.
2. Fluency, Pronunciation & Intonation	____ / 2.5 P.	____ / 2.5 P.	____ / 5.0 P.
3. Lexical Range & Grammatical Accuracy (B1)	____ / 2.5 P.	____ / 2.5 P.	____ / 5.0 P.
TOTAL PART 5 (ORAL SPEAKING SCORE)	**____ / 7.5 P.**	**____ / 7.5 P.**	**____ / 15.0 P.**

Examiner 1 (Name & Signature): _____ Examiner 2 (Name & Signature): _____ Date: 16.10.2026